

Why is it bad that ai uses absurd amounts of water?

Posted by u/B1GB0SSsOLDtHEwORLD • 0 points • 2 comments

I'm genuinely curious because I was under the assumption that the water used for cooling (similar to nuclear power plants) would just re-integrate into the water cycle?

I could say "the corn industry in America wastes billions of gallons of water per year" but anyone who understands basic science knows that water isn't actually gone.. so how is this different? Thanks in advance!

Comments

u/Justsomedudeonthenet • 1 points • 2025-12-24 00:25 UTC

The problem is that they are using **drinking water** that has to be cleaned and processed before it's used. They aren't slurping it up directly from the ocean and pumping it back in after warming it up a little. They're taking drinking water from the same sources your house gets it's water, and either evaporating it or dumping it back into the sewer or nearby water sources.

The water still exists, of course. But it puts a massive strain on the water treatment facilities, and on the water supply in general in drought prone areas.

u/BlackSparowSF • 1 points • 2025-12-24 00:23 UTC

Because it's a new industry that pulls massive amounts of water from a limited supply that was already barely enough for everything else